Official delegate reference manual

Nath Valley School ISMUN rules of procedure

Letter from the secretariat

Greetings delegates,
Before the conference we found it of utmost importance to create a document encompassing all the rules of procedure and formal structure that will be followed in ISMUN.
This document contains all the basic information pertaining to what committees are, how they work and what exactly delegates are to do.
We assure you that the 2 days of conference will not only forge alliances but friendships as well, you will with your head brimming full of facts and an invigorated spirit.
We recommend all first timers to go through this document at least once.
Lastly, remember to have fun and enjoy the process. As your Executive Board, we are here to guide and support you throughout the conference. Whether it is a question of procedure or clarity on your portfolio, feel free to reach out to us at the email given below.

Until October

The secretariat,

ismunnathvalleyschool@gmail.com

Structure of committees

In ISMUN, we broadly have 3 types of committees, stated and structured as so:

General assemblies and bodies:

This includes beginner friendly committees like the UNGA, WHO, HRC, and so on. The essential focus here will be international security and policy. Delegates will act as member states of the particular committee they are allocated. Closure of this committee will be with formal drafts, these can be working papers, draft resolutions or paper work by the discretion of the EB. The pace for these committees is structured, formal and easy to keep track of, as the day and its deliberations continue.

Specialised committees:

Specialised committees are recommended to those with at least 3 previous MUN experiences, some of them are ODC and SRA. Specialised committees tend to focus on technical and legal based regional issues ranging from blockades to arms races. Delegates will take the role of member states in these committees. For the output, paperwork like action orders, working papers or draft resolution will be looked upon favourably. These committees are slightly fast paced and tend to be more detail based as delegates debate to resolve the issues.

Crisis committees:

Here at ISMUN, we also stimulate crisis committees like the HSC and JCC. Delegates with extensive experience are expected here. The issues here will be real time, with constant updates in the form of "crisis updates". These will however not always be rooted in reality. The delegates will be either member states or specific portfolios of world leaders. The form of debate is rapid, reactive and encourages delegates to think on their feet. For paperwork, there will be communiques, action orders, working papers, draft resolutions, all depending upon the discretion of the EB and as per the time restraints so that all delegates can participate.

Indian committees:

Indian committees recreate the various executive cabins we have in the Indian political system. These tend to be either the LOK SABHA or the AIPPM. Delegates are assigned portfolios of various Indian ministers from both the right and left wing. They are required to debate on relevant issues going on in the country while maintaining the political alliances. For paperwork, there might be a "bill" formed and passed, however this will again be up to the discretion of the EB, delegates are encouraged to speak up in this dynamic committee.

Points to note:

- All paperwork will not be made mandatory in every committee, it will be decided upon the experience of the delegates and how much the paperwork will add to committee productivity. However, keeping that in mind, delegates must be prepared regardless.
- All committees will in fact experience crises at least once, as this will create a vigorous environment in the committee, encourage on the spot deliberation, and prepare delegates for future conferences.

Flow of committee

Committee flow will begin on day 1 following the opening ceremony and end the next day before the closing ceremony. There will be around 5 committee sessions in all.

Setting the agenda

At ISMUN, the agenda is limited to the single topic area outlined in each committee's study guide. Thus, voting to set the agenda is a mere formality. As soon as the committee begins, a motion to set the agenda for the topic area must be raised. Please note that the Secretary General has the final authority on which topics may be voted on to be introduced in committee.

Debate

Debate may be carried out through:

1. General Speakers' List
2. Special Speakers' List
3. Moderated Caucus
4. Unmoderated Caucus

General Speakers' List

The General Speakers' List is open throughout the course of committee for general debate and discussion of the topic area. Motions to open any other medium of debate will not close the General Speakers' List but will only overlap it. Hence, if a country is in the queue to speak on the List and another medium of debate is opened, the country will remain in that position and get to make a speech if and when the General Speakers' List is reverted to. Delegates are recognised for the General Speakers' List on a first come first serve basis provided that the delegate is not already on the list. Anything within the scope of the topic area may be discussed. The General Speakers' List may never be closed, each speech would be around 90 seconds.

If the GSL elapses it motions that a committee has failed.

Special Speakers' List

The Special Speakers' List is almost like the General Speakers' List, except that it must be motioned for. This list is opened for a specific time period to discuss a particular topic within the topic area. While motioning to open it, the purpose and time limit must be specified. Speakers may only discuss the issue that the Special Speakers' List was opened to discuss. Delegates are to note that special speakers lists are only to be motioned for in the event of a crisis.

Yields

When a speaker delivers a noncontroversial speech, two comments are in order. If, however, the content of your speech needs further explanation or is highly controversial, it is recommended that you utilise yields. At the end of your speech, inform the Moderator that you will be yielding your time. You may yield your time:

1. To questions, If a speaker yields their time to questions, they may be asked and answered in accordance with the time the speaker has remaining and the discretion of the Director.

2. To the Chair/Director, If time is yielded directly to the Chair/Director, that time is saved, and the List moves on to the next speaker.

3. To another delegate, Time may also be yielded to another delegate in committee if the current speaker so desires, who then gets to speak for the remaining amount of time. It is important that delegates discuss yielding of time amongst one and another informally before declaring so in committee, as it can lead to wastage of time.

Moderated Caucus

The purpose of a moderated caucus is to facilitate substantive debate at critical junctures in the discussion. These motions are raised with a defined subtopics based on the agenda, total time and per speaker time, and their approval rests entirely in the hands of the Executive Board and is not subject to appeal. During a moderated caucus, the Director will suspend the Speakers List, and delegates will

be recognised to speak. Please note that, Moderated Caucuses are concise and discuss specific subtopics within the committee's agenda.

Unmoderated Caucus

This is essentially an informal discussion amongst delegates and has no procedural rules. Delegates generally use it to lobby with each other and formulate paperwork. It must be motioned for with a specific time but may be passed only at the Executive Board's discretion.

Points

There are 4 different types of points as follows

1. Point of Personal Privilege

Whenever a delegate experiences extreme discomfort, which impairs them from partaking in committee proceedings, they may rise to a Point of Personal Privilege, so that the discomfort may be mitigated. It is the only point which may interrupt a speaker and thus must be used with the utmost discretion. Delegates may raise Points of Personal Privilege by lifting their placards.

2. Point of Order

During the discussion of any matter, if a delegate feels that there is a factual inaccuracy in the speech of another delegate or that they have been misquoted by another delegate, so much so that it affects committee proceedings, then they may make a Point of Order. The delegate raising it must quote the statement that they believe is inaccurate while also providing a source to support their claim. This point may be raised to the Executive Board by raising one's placard; if it is valid, it will be read out in committee. Good Points of Order will be duly noted.

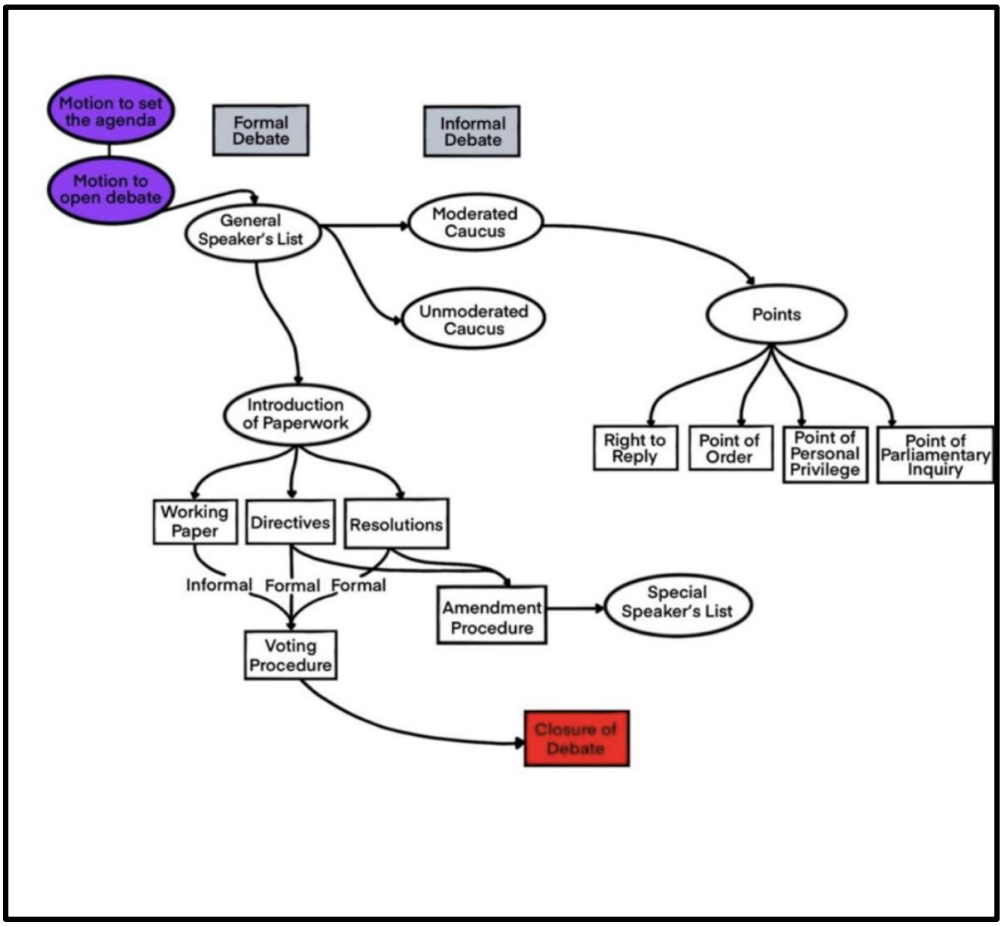
3. Point of information

Points of information are essentially questions aimed at a delegate. They are generally raised after a delegate is done speaking. These may not interrupt a speaker.

4. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry
When the floor is open, a delegate may rise to a Point of Parliamentary Inquiry to ask a question regarding the rules of procedure. This may never interrupt a speaker.

5. Right to reply
The right to reply is not in actuality a point, but must be raised as so. It is to be raised if the head of state of a particular country has been offended or the delegate themselves. We request that this right not be abused or used without reason.

Here is an extensive flowchart about committee procedure. Delegates please note that only the points stated in this document will be strictly adhered to, if there are any new procedures to be followed the delegates will be informed of them before.



Precedence of Motions Motions

Motions at ISMUN will be voted upon in order of disruption, and not in order of introduction. Moderated caucuses with a greater total time period are deemed more disruptive than a moderated caucus with a lesser total time period. The following is a list of motions, in descending order of disruption:

1. Motion to Open/Adjourn/Close Debate
2. Point of Personal Privilege
3. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry
4. Right to Reply
5. Introduction of a Resolution/Directive
6. Introduction of an Amendment to a Resolution/Directive
7. Introduction of a Working Paper
8. Motion to move into Formal Voting Procedure
9. Motion to open a Special Speakers List
10. Extension of an Unmoderated Caucus
11. Extension of a Moderated Caucus
12. Introduction of a Moderated Caucus
13. Introduction of a Question & Answer Session

Voting mechanisms

Mainly there will be 2 types of votings

1. Procedural voting

This includes voting upon the parliamentary procedures that are to take place in committee like setting of agenda or moderated caucus topics. The passing for this will be a simple majority, that is 50% + 1 of the committee.

2. Substantive voting

This applies to voting upon paper work and other amendments that are to be passed after discussion in committee. The pass margin here will be a special majority, that is the 2/3rd strength of delegates voting in the committee.

It is to be noted that delegates can mark themselves “present” or “present and voting” during the attendance. Those “present and voting” will not be allowed to abstain from voting.